

ROBIN YIFAN LUO

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EDUCATION

University of Washington, Seattle, Ph.D. in Finance	<i>Expected June 2027</i>
University of British Columbia, M.Sc. in Finance	<i>2021</i>
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, M.Sc. in Economics	<i>2019</i>
University of Nottingham, B.Sc. with Honours in Economics	<i>2018</i>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Corporate Finance, Financial Intermediation, Industrial Organization

JOB MARKET PAPER

Misallocation in Banking, solo-authored *Draft available upon request*

I develop and estimate a two-sided oligopolistic model of U.S. banking to measure how uneven bank pricing power misallocates deposits and loans. Estimated annual welfare losses range from \$1.3 to \$3.1 billion (2019 dollars), with deposit-loan complementarities offsetting a substantial share. The framework also evaluates how mergers, monetary tightening, and banking stress shift banks relative to efficient marginal-surplus benchmarks.

PUBLICATION

In Search of a Unicorn: Dynamic Agency with Endogenous Investment Opportunities, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Beatrice Michaeli

Journal of Accounting and Economics, 2024. [\[SSRN\]](#)

Develops a dynamic contracting model in which privately observed opportunities arrive through costly search. The optimal contract generates time-varying investment thresholds, internal search charges, and empirically testable overinvestment patterns.

WORKING PAPERS

The Optimal Schedules of Incentives and Cash Flows, with Felix Zhiyu Feng and Mark M. Westerfield

Studies delegated management when observable output combines investment in durable asset quality and instantaneous effort. Optimal incentives begin back-loaded and can become front-loaded as promised future incentives accumulate, generating cash-flow mean reversion and implications for the duration of incentives.

Clientele Specialization, Stable Capital, and Value in Asset Management, with Hossein Poorvasei

Draft available upon request

Using 4,391 U.S. separately managed account products, documents that clientele specialization predicts more durable funding, more stable exposures, and higher gross-of-fee alpha. A model links relationship-specific investment to funding stability, scale, and the division of gains between managers and clients.

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Funding Channel of Monetary Policy, with Germán Gutiérrez and Hossein Poorvasei *draft in progress*

Examines how monetary policy affects bank credit by reshaping the prices and quantities of all bank liabilities.

Production Functions in Asset Management, with Ahmed Guecioueur

Recovers heterogeneity in production functions across fund families.

TEACHING AND STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

Teaching Assistant, University of Washington *2022–2026*

- EMBA 520: Financial Management, for Jonathan Karpoff
- EMBA 540: International Finance, for Stephan Siegel
- TMMBA 501: Microeconomics for Technology Managers, for Alexis León
- **Evidence of effectiveness:** Median rating of 4.7/5.0 across seven Executive MBA sections (range 4.5–4.9). Recipient of EMBA Teaching Recognition Award.

- Designed and led a ten-session EMBA 520 review sequence covering present value, forecasting, valuation, CAPM, WACC, capital structure, governance, and an integrated case. Developed Excel workbooks with guided practice and offered individual support to students with varied professional and quantitative backgrounds.

Teaching interests: Corporate finance, applied financial markets, investment theory, valuation and financial modeling, financial institutions and banking, international finance, microeconomics, statistics, ML/AI.

PRESENTATIONS

Conferences and invited seminars (presented by coauthor)*

2026: Finance Theory Group Fall Meeting*, FMA Annual Meeting, FIRS Conference*, Econometric Society North American Summer Meeting*

2025: Financial Theory Group Summer School, Southwest Finance Association, Eastern Finance Association*

2023: CES North America Conference, Organizational Economics Workshop*, 33rd Stony Brook International Conference on Game Theory*

2022: Financial Markets and Corporate Governance Conference*, Research Symposium on Finance and Economics, Asia-Pacific Association of Derivatives, Australasian Finance & Banking Conference, China International Conference in Finance*, HKUST Accounting Research Symposium*

SERVICES

Ph.D. Student Mentor, UW Foster 2024–2026

Doctoral Business Students Association Representative, UW Foster 2025

Co-Organizer, Finance Ph.D. Brownbag, UW Foster 2022–2024

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

Dean's Achievement Award, UW Foster

EMBA Teaching Recognition Award, UW Foster

UW Ph.D. Fellowship

M.Sc. Student Merit Scholarship, HKUST

Head's Scholarship, University of Nottingham

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

Programming: R, MATLAB, Python, Stata, SQL, L^AT_EX

Languages: Mandarin (native), English (fluent), French (basic), Cantonese (basic)

Interests: Hiking, bouldering, concerts, acoustic guitar

REFERENCES

Mark M. Westerfield (Chair)

Professor of Finance and Business Economics, Michael G.

Foster Endowed Professor

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Germán Gutiérrez

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